Product Selection and Testing

Week 4 Concept Selection Review

MKT3717 Product and Brand Management

Dr. Dayoung Kim

Announcement

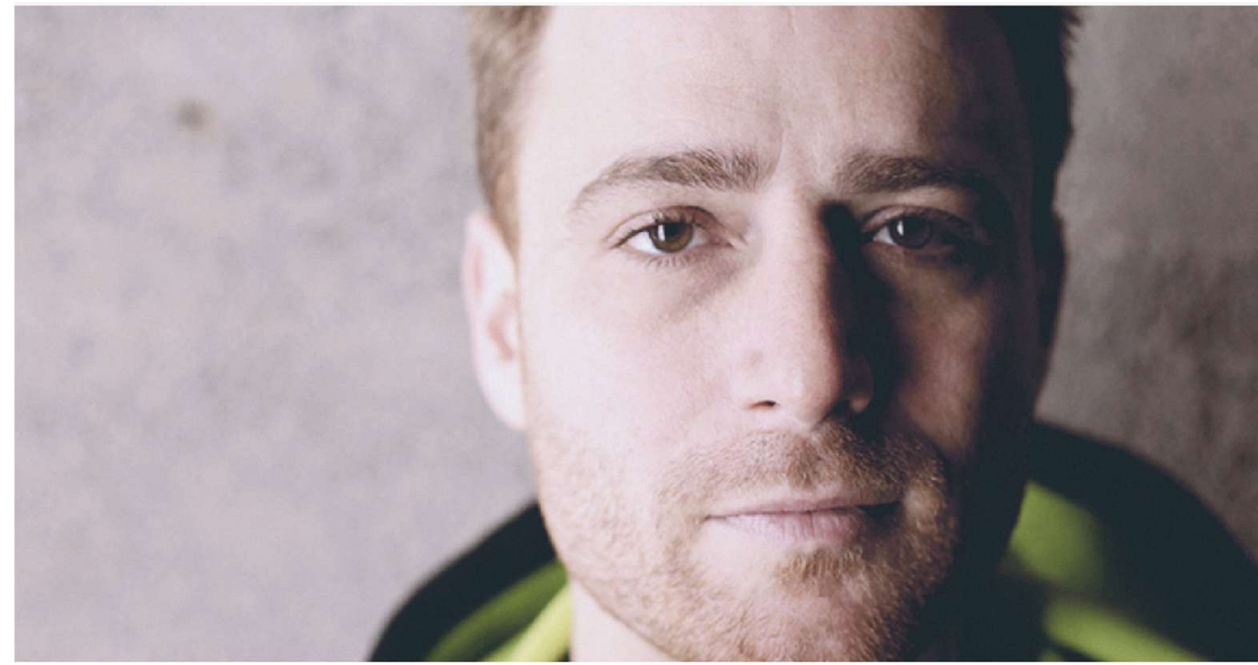
- Read your final project guide and start working on it!

- Today
  - Concept Scoring Matrix Review
  - Guest Speaker (in Redesigning Experience)

- Next Week
  - Analytic methods (conjoint analysis) as concept testing tools
  - Considerations in product development and launch
    - Pre-read article: Slack’s founder shares their epic launch strategy

Read the Article (for next week)

What are the key takeaways behind Slack's product development and launch strategy?



Product

From 0 to $1B - Slack's Founder Shares Their Epic Launch Strategy

Last Week (Concept Selection Process: Cont'd)

- Keep only the top-ranked solution (among product concepts)
- Concept Screening
  - Create and name the combinations
  - Prepare the matrix with criteria, reference concept and weighting
- Rate concepts
  - Scale (+, 0, -) or (1,2,3,4,5)
  - Compare to reference concept
- Concept Scoring
  - **Sum weighted scores**
  - Continuous improvement

Concept Scoring Matrix

1. Prepare the matrix
   - Use the Criteria weights from the problem surveys
2. Rate concepts using scores based on quantitative analysis
3. Rank them
4. Combine and improve
   - Can you cancel the negatives by combining?
5. Select one or more concepts for each function
6. Reflect and get consensus
   - What metrics are you least confident of?
   - Any criteria missing?

- Example of concept scoring matrix to select a spill-proof cup holder to be used on the boat

		Concept A		Concept C		Concept F		Concept I		Concept J		Concept K		Concept O	
Selection Criteria	**Weight**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**	**Rating**	**Weighted Score**
Flexible Use	20														
Use in different locations	15	7	105	7	105	8	120	6	90	6	90	5	75	7	105
Holds different beverages	5	5	25	5	25	3	15	4	20	5	25	3	15	3	15
Maintains Drink Condition	15														
Retains temperature of drink	13	5	65	5	65	5	65	1	13	5	65	5	65	5	65
Prevents water from getting in	2	5	10	7	14	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10
Survives Boating Environment	5														
Doesn't break when dropped	1	6	6	6	6	9	9	7	7	5	5	9	9	6	6
Resists corrosion from sea spray	2	7	14	7	14	8	16	8	16	5	10	9	18	7	14
Floats when it falls in water	2	5	10	6	12	8	16	4	8	5	10	8	16	7	14
Keeps Drink Container Stable	20														
Prevents spilling	7	3	21	4	28	3	21	5	35	5	35	3	21	3	21
Prevents bouncing in waves	6	7	42	8	48	7	42	5	30	5	30	7	42	7	42
Will not slide during pitch/roll	7	5	35	5	35	5	35	5	35	5	35	5	35	5	35
Requires Little Maintenance	5														
Easily stored when not in use	1	7	7	6	6	8	8	9	9	4	4	8	8	7	7
Easy to maintain a clean appearance	2	6	12	6	12	3	6	4	8	5	10	5	10	6	12
Allows liquid to drain out bottom	2	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10	5	10
Easy to Use	15														
Usable with one hand	5	7	35	7	35	7	35	6	30	5	25	7	35	7	35
Easy/comfortable to grip	5	8	40	8	40	6	30	5	25	5	25	6	30	8	40
Easy to exchange beverage containers	2	5	10	5	10	5	10	8	16	5	10	5	10	5	10
Works reliably	3	3	9	3	9	3	9	3	9	4	12	4	12	3	9
Attractive in Environment	10														
Doesn't damage boat surface	5	8	40	8	40	8	40	8	40	8	40	6	30	8	40
Attractive to look at	5	7	35	8	40	3	15	4	20	5	25	5	25	8	40
Manufacturing Ease	10														
Low-cost materials	4	5	20	4	16	7	28	8	32	4	16	8	32	6	24
Low complexity of parts	3	4	12	3	9	7	21	4	12	3	9	8	24	5	15
Low number of assembly steps	3	5	15	5	15	8	24	3	9	3	9	8	24	6	18
Total Score			578		594		585		484		510		556		587
Rank			4		1		3		7		6		5		2

Debrief: Mechanical Pencil Concept Scoring

- Why did different teams choose different ‘best’ concepts?

- Communication challenges?
  - Who would win this debate in a real firm?

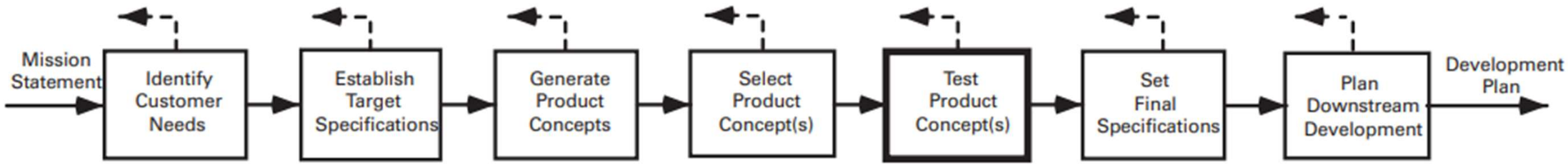
- Why might a concept scoring matrix select a product that is worse?
  - Which features from the losing concepts would you steal?

Concept Scoring Matrix: Takeaways and Caveats

- Beware of selecting the *best average* product.
  - Note features which can be applied to other concepts.
- Perform concept selection for different **customer group** and compare results.
- Check sensitivity of selection to importance **weightings** and any uncertain ratings.
- The full set of detailed requirements can be used in the final stages of selection.

The ultimate goal of concept evaluation is to <u>create and develop</u> the best concept, rather than just selecting the best concept.
Remember to <u>combine and refine</u> the concepts to develop better ones!

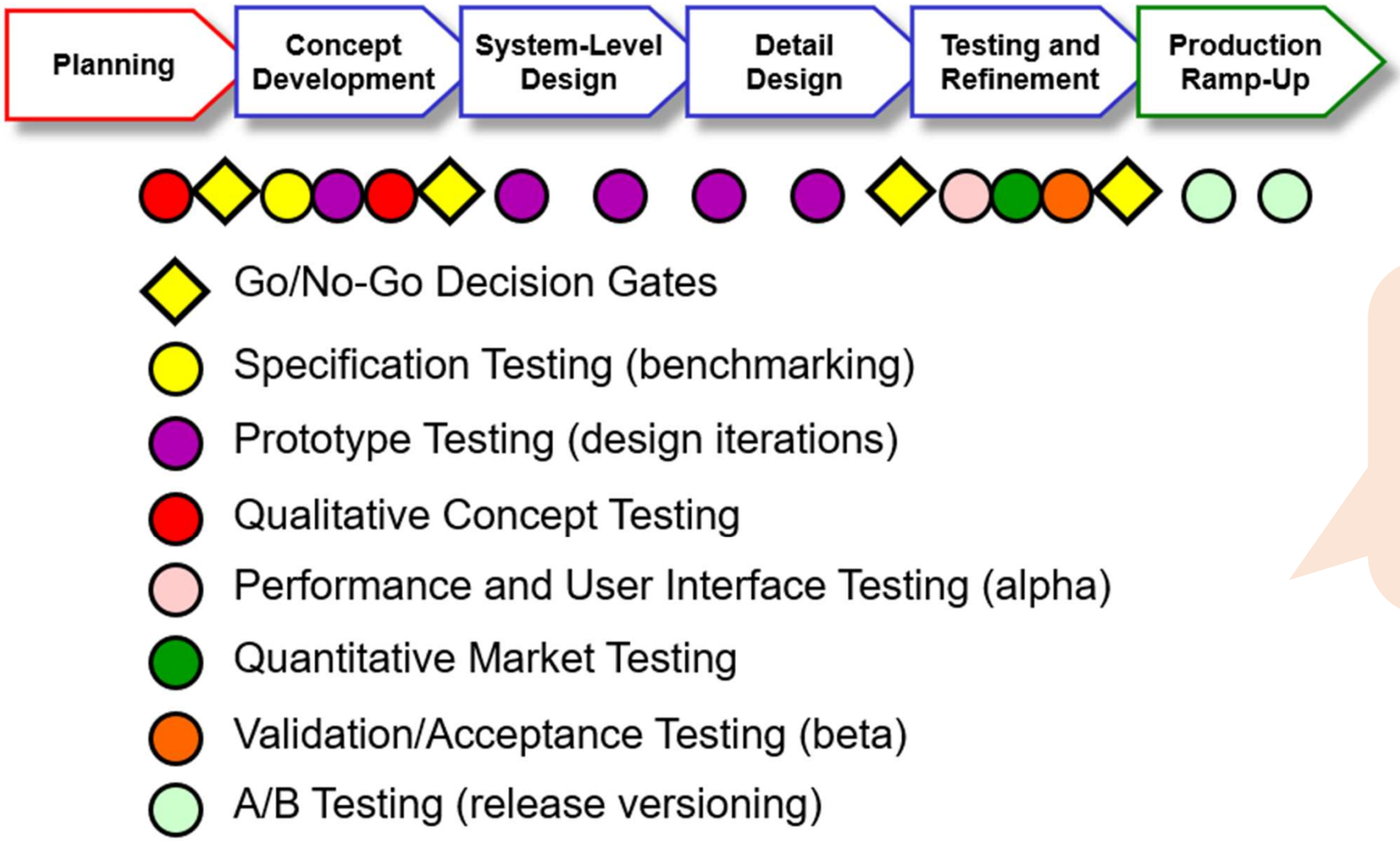
Phase 3. Concept Testing



Testing evolves from 'Should we build this?' to 'How do we make it work better at scale?'

- A stage of elimination
- Following the PIC should result in excluding the concepts
  - requiring technologies that firm does not have.
  - to be sold to customers about whom the firm has no close knowledge.
  - offering too much (or too little) innovativeness.
  - wrong on other dimensions: high cost, too close to certain competitors, etc.

Testing in the Product Development Process



Not testing your ideas is a great way to fail fast!

Guest Lecture

Jeungmin Kim

Director of the Contents Lab @ *SeeArt Foundation (Korea)*

Library Director @ *For My Stories*

Jeungmin reimagines public libraries as exploration-driven environments for young people. Her work integrates youth exploration, story-centered experience design, and behavioral insights to reshape how public libraries ignite curiosity and creativity in the next generation.

"Creativity is just having enough dots to connect.”

Steve Jobs

THANK YOU

Group Creativity (Brainstorming)

Some Common Rules

- Defer judgment of ideas
- Build on the ideas of others
- Encourage wild ideas
- Express ideas visually
- Stay focused on the topic
- One conversation at a time
- Use stimuli related to the topic

Setting It Up

- Advance prep
- Stimulating space
- 4 to 8 people
- Paper and markers
- White boards
- Coffee and snacks
- Skilled facilitator